

Idioms.

An idiom is a common word or phrase with a culturally understood meaning that differs from what its composite words' denotations would suggest; i.e. the words together have a meaning that is different from the dictionary definitions of the individual words.

1. The ball is in your court

= used to say that YOU now have control of the situation

The ball is in their court now. Let's wait for their decision.

2. be in hot water

= to be in trouble

Ken was in hot water about forgetting his wedding anniversary.

3. a long haul

= the long road; the option that takes the most time

Peter told his boss that he wouldn't quit. He's in it for the long haul.

4. know/learn the ropes

= the process of learning about sth so you are comfortable with it

It took me a month to learn the ropes at my new job.

5. set the record straight

= to clarify what is true/factual about a story or thing

In a TV interview, the politician set the record straight about his experiences in the military.

6. line of work

= job field; type of work

The fireman said that injuries were common in his line of work.

7. burn your bridges

= ruin a relationship, resulting in you being unable to return somewhere

Jack tried to be kind to his boss when he quit in job because he didn't want to burn his bridges.

8. get/be given the sack / sack (verb)

to be fired

Alan got the sack for repeatedly coming into work late.